



Steam Machine?

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Bazaar

Lenovo IdeaTab Lynx K3011

A very functional Windows 8 hybrid

There are two parts to this product - the Lynx as a tablet, and the overall package with the keyboard dock attached. Weighs just more than 640 grams as a tablet, and the keyboard dock adds another 660 grams to the weight. In combination, the entire package weighs pretty much like an ultrabook. There is no doubt that the Lynx is good to look at, with the darker colour tone at the front and the lighter rubberized finish at the back. However, the in-hand feel of the tablet isn't one that is the most premium. The back panel flexes when you push in near the Lenovo logo, and tapping on it brings out a rather hollow sound.

The critical aspect is its keyboard. The key design is very similar to some of the recent IdeaPad and Yoga machines. The problem is the curve design at the bottom of every key, which makes it difficult for the fingers to really get used to the layout without a learning curve. Touchpad isn't very big, but the precision is consistent.

But, the way Lenovo has blended the two together makes the Lynx look like a clamshell mini-laptop, rather than two separate devices joined together.

The 11.6-inch screen on the Lynx does not have a Full HD resolution, and instead is limited to 1366 x 768 pixels. In the proper tablet mode, we would have much more appreciated a higher res screen to bring it in line with the Android tablets in the same price bracket. However, the display is crisp, colour reproduction is not as vivid as some of the AMOLED screens, but the IPS panel means the colours are extremely accurate. As a tablet for multimedia consumption or in the docked mode when you may be reading a bunch of text, this IPS screen is extremely comfortable. Hopefully, with the next update, the resolution will be bumped up as well. Touchscreen response is accurate and quick, and that just makes using Windows 8.1 a lot more fun.

Lenovo claims 8 hours of battery life from the tablet's battery, and another 8 hours with the dock's additional pack. For the tablet battery, we registered an impressive 6.5 hours in our battery benchmark, run at full load and 100% display brightness. Translate this into a typical usage scenario at work or at home, and you will usually never have brightness levels above 50%. That will mean you will get more than 8 hours on a single charge, which is what we experienced.

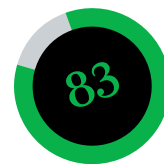


Even without having to carry the dock around, the IdeaTab Lynx is good enough to last a complete day at work.

The Clovertrail based Atom Z2760 dual core processor, paired with 2GB of RAM, is no performance charts scorching. In the benchmark tests, PC Mark 07 score, registered at 1431, is pretty much in range of most other Windows 8 convertibles - HP Slate x2 and the Asus VivoTab. The real world performance is very smooth, although you cannot really multi-task on this machine, beyond a point. Within the power package limitations, you get a very competent performer, with the main focus being good battery life, albeit very successfully. The 64GB flash storage is fairly quick, booting into Windows 8 in about 11 seconds. The 2GB RAM does prove to be a limitation when you open 10 tabs in Chrome and want to open iTunes in the background - app opening times become that much longer. But, for most typical home and home office uses, tasks like multimedia viewing, web browsing, emails and document creation - the IdeaTab Lynx works very smoothly.

All things considered, there is enough evidence of the IdeaTab Lynx to be a very functional and reliable performer, with the extreme flexibility of the proper tablet mode and the keyboard dock. That, and the good battery life makes this a device that is very usable. The IPS screen, albeit not Full HD, is very good as well.

Vishal Mathur



Features.....	80
Performance.....	85
Build.....	85
Value.....	80

Specifications

Processor: Intel Atom Z2760; **RAM:** 2GB; **Display:** 11.6-inch IPS (1366 x 768 pixel); **Storage:** 64GB flash + expandable; **OS:** Windows 8.1

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